

Teacher card

Christmas and Christian belief / GROW_RE_A1_W05

Outcome: Explain how one Christmas tradition links to a Christian belief.

Evidence to retain: F: one tradition linked to a belief using “This links to... because...”.

Forty minute route

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.
Pause time is flexible.

Preparation

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Keep cultural and religious Christmas distinct; model ‘for Christians...’; check understanding of belief before asking for explanation.

Access and regulation

Visual matching; reduced reading; one tradition minimum; sentence stems; option to speak/record response; extension through a second example.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

This is learning about religion and worldviews, not worship. Nobody is asked to share a personal belief, family detail or loss.

Assessment

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner’s individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner’s evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

Model and answers

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: Name one belief connected to Christmas.

Evidence: A The belief: Christians believe Jesus is the Son of God. The incarnation means God became human in Jesus. Christmas celebrates his birth.

Think aloud: The incarnation: God became human in Jesus.

Check: Is every Christmas tradition a Christian belief? No. Some traditions are cultural.

Arrival answers

1. Remembering the rededication of the Temple, faith or hope.
2. The Christian belief that God became human in Jesus
3. The incarnation: God became human in Jesus.
4. No. Some traditions are cultural.

Shared activity reasoning

1. A Nativity play — The birth of Jesus. Card B: it retells the Nativity.
2. Advent candles — Jesus as the light of the world. Card C: light points to Jesus.
3. Pulling crackers — Cultural, not a belief. Card D: enjoyed by people of all worldviews.

Exit responses

Name one belief connected to Christmas. The incarnation: God became human in Jesus.

Is every Christmas tradition a Christian belief? No. Some traditions are cultural.

Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Arrival: 4 retrieval questions. Starter: tradition or belief? quick sort. I Do: link selected Christmas practices to Christian beliefs about Jesus. We Do: match tradition cards to belief/meaning cards. You Do: choose one tradition and explain its religious meaning using 'This links to... because...'. Exit ticket: one belief connected to Christmas.

Look for

F: one tradition linked to a belief using "This links to... because...".

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

Source credits

Luke 2 Christian Nativity account

<https://www.biblegateway.com/passage/?search=Luke+2&version=KJV>

Matthew 2 Christian Nativity account

<https://www.biblegateway.com/passage/?search=Matthew+2&version=KJV>

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources_and_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.